

Qwen3.8-Max on Qwen Studio

Step-by-step setup & usage guide (free tier)

Web Chat
<code>chat.qwen.ai</code>
API Base URL (international)
<code>https://dashscope-intl.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1</code>
API Base URL (China/Beijing)
<code>https://dashscope.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1</code>
Model ID
<code>qwen3.8-max</code>

Step 1 — Create your account

Go to chat.qwen.ai and sign up with Google or email. No credit card required to use the free web chat.

Step 2 — Select Qwen3.8-Max

In the chat interface, open the model dropdown and choose **Qwen3.8-Max-0902** — it's Alibaba's current flagship model, tagged as the latest release.

Step 3 — Test it in the browser first

Try a long-context or coding task directly in the web chat to get a feel for the model before wiring it into anything. This confirms quality and response style with zero setup.

Step 4 — Get a DashScope API key (for code use)

Go to the Alibaba Cloud Model Studio / DashScope console, create an account if needed, and generate an API key under API Keys. This is what unlocks programmatic access beyond the web chat.

Step 5 — Pick the correct API base URL for your region

Use `https://dashscope-intl.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1` for international access, or `https://dashscope.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1` if you're on the China/Beijing console. This endpoint is OpenAI-SDK compatible.

Step 6 — Set up the connection in code

Since the endpoint is OpenAI-compatible, you only change 3 things — key, base URL, model name. See the code block below.

```
import os
from openai import OpenAI

client = OpenAI(
    api_key=os.getenv("DASHSCOPE_API_KEY"),
    base_url="https://dashscope-intl.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1",
)

completion = client.chat.completions.create(
    model="qwen3.8-max",
    messages=[
        {"role": "user", "content": "Hello! Tell me a fun fact about AI."}
    ],
)

print(completion.choices[0].message.content)
```

Step 7 — Or plug it into a coding tool

In Cline, Cursor, Claude Code, or any OpenAI-compatible client, set the base URL to the DashScope endpoint above, paste your API key, and set the model to `qwen3.8-max`.

Step 8 — Watch your limits

Free access on flagship models typically comes with daily or per-minute rate caps that can tighten without notice — check the Model Studio console occasionally to confirm current limits.

Notes: Qwen3.8-Max-0902 is Alibaba's flagship reasoning and coding model, built for agentic workflows with a large context window. Free-tier availability and rate limits can change without notice — always confirm current limits on the Model Studio / DashScope console before relying on it in production.